



Tips & Tricks



Finding the size of a folder or sub-folder

To find the size of a current folder, type the following code:

```
du -sh
```

To find the size of all sub-folders and files in the current folder, type in:

```
du * -sh
```

Note:

s stands for 'summarise'

h stands for 'human readable format'

—sumeet, inanisumeet@yahoo.com



Install and use your own JDK on Linux

We know that all Linux distros give us JDK in the installation media. If you want to install your own JDK and use it, here is one trick that I hope will help you.

Set the PATH environment variable.

If your installed JDK is on the /home/xyz/JDK directory and you want to enable it, follow the steps given below.

Log in as the root user on the shell prompt and type the following command:

```
export PATH=/home/xyz/JDK/bin:$PATH
```

Put this command in the /etc/bashrc file and restart your terminal.

—Nirav Joshi, nirav.joshi@narolainfotech.com



Mounting an ISO image without a DVD drive

Let's suppose you have a DVD image file of a distro and you want to extract a few files from it, but you either do not have a DVD to burn the image or you do not want to waste a blank DVD. Here's how you can mount an ISO image as a filesystem.

First, make a directory that will be the mount point for the ISO image:

```
# mkdir /iso0
```

```
# mount -o loop -t iso9660 /FC2-1386-DVD.iso /iso0
```

Or to mount automatically at boot, add the following to "/etc/fstab"

```
/FC2-1386-DVD.iso /iso0 iso9660 rw,loop 0 0
```

—Gururaj Rao, raogrr@yahoo.co.in



Information about the executable

This tip is for those who work on cross compilers with multiple platforms/architectures. The `readelf` command can be used to check an executable's architecture to which a compiler is bound to work, along with other useful information.

```
readelf -h <executable_name>
```

Typical example:

```
[root@bala backup]# readelf -h both
```

ELF Header:

Magic:

```
7f 45 4c 46 01 01 01 00 00  
00 00 00 00 00 00 00
```

Class:

ELF32

Data:

2's complement, little endian

Version:

1 (current)

OS/ABI:

UNIX - System V

ABI Version:

0

Type:

EXEC (Executable file)

Machine:

Intel 80386

Version:

0x1

Entry point address:

0x80487e0

Start of program headers:

52 (bytes into file)